

Linux Interview Questions

1. What is Linux, and how is it different from Windows?
 2. Explain the difference between UNIX and Linux.
 3. What is the difference between Linux distributions (RHEL, Ubuntu, CentOS, etc.)?
 4. Explain the Linux boot process.
 5. What are runlevels (or systemd targets)?
 6. How do you check the current Linux version and kernel version?
 7. What is the difference between absolute and relative paths?
 8. Explain the difference between soft link and hard link.
 9. How do you check disk usage and free space? (commands: df, du)
 10. How do you check memory and CPU usage?
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11. What is the difference between a process and a thread in Linux?
 12. How do you check running processes? (commands: ps, top, htop)
 13. Explain the difference between /etc/passwd and /etc/shadow.
 14. How do you create a new user and assign a password?
 15. How do you schedule a job in Linux? Difference between cron and at.
 16. Explain file permissions in Linux (read, write, execute).
 17. How do you change permissions and ownership (chmod, chown, chgrp)?
 18. Explain the difference between find and locate commands.
 19. What is the difference between a daemon and a service?
 20. How do you check logs in Linux? Where are logs stored?
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1. Explain the difference between TCP and UDP in Linux networking.
2. How do you troubleshoot a network issue (commands: ping, netstat, ss, traceroute, tcpdump)?
3. What is SELinux/AppArmor? How do they work?
4. Explain the difference between hard disk partitions (MBR vs GPT).

5. What is LVM (Logical Volume Manager), and how do you create LVM volumes?
 6. What is RAID? Difference between RAID 0, 1, 5, 10.
 7. What is the difference between SAN, NAS, and DAS?
 8. How do you mount an NFS share in Linux?
 9. What is iSCSI, and how do you configure it?
 10. What is the difference between systemd and init?
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1. A server is running slow, how do you troubleshoot?
 2. A user cannot log in — what steps will you take?
 3. Disk space is full, how will you find large files and free space?
 4. A service is not starting, how do you debug it?
 5. Network is unreachable, how do you fix it?
 1. What is Linux, and how is it different from UNIX?
 2. Explain the Linux directory structure.
 3. What is the difference between relative and absolute paths?
 4. What are hard links and soft links?
 5. What is the difference between Linux and Windows file systems?
 6. Explain file permissions in Linux (r, w, x).
 7. What is the difference between chmod, chown, and chgrp?
 8. How do you check system uptime?
 9. How do you find the current logged-in users?
 10. What is the difference between /bin, /sbin, /usr/bin, and /usr/sbin?
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11. Explain the Linux boot process.
12. What are runlevels / systemd targets?
13. How do you check memory and CPU usage?
14. What is the difference between a process and a thread?
15. What is the difference between ps, top, and htop?
16. How do you schedule tasks in Linux? Difference between cron and at.
17. What is the difference between /etc/passwd and /etc/shadow?
18. How do you create a new user and assign groups?

19. Explain sticky bit, SUID, and SGID in Linux.
 20. How do you check which processes are using a file or port?
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21. What is the difference between TCP and UDP?
 22. How do you troubleshoot network connectivity in Linux?
 23. Explain the difference between SAN, NAS, and DAS.
 24. What is LVM? How do you create and extend a logical volume?
 25. Explain the difference between ext3, ext4, and xfs file systems.
 26. What is RAID? Explain RAID levels.
 27. What is SELinux/AppArmor?
 28. What is iSCSI, and where is it used?
 29. Explain the difference between init and systemd.
 30. How do you mount NFS and CIFS shares?
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31. A user cannot log in — how do you troubleshoot?
32. A server is running slow — what steps will you take?
33. Disk space is full — how will you find and clear space?
34. A service is not starting — how will you debug?
35. The network is unreachable — what troubleshooting steps will you follow?
36. The server is not booting — how do you fix it?
37. Logs are filling up the disk — how will you handle it?
38. You suspect high I/O wait — how will you confirm and fix it?
39. How do you recover a deleted file in Linux?
40. How do you secure SSH on a Linux server?